EasyModeBtw manual

Play any scale on the white keys. A MIDI effect for Linux: the white keys play the notes of the scale you pick, the black keys are silent, and the scale's root sits on middle C.

Version 0.1.5. To install it, see the README.

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Getting started

EasyModeBtw goes **in front of an instrument**, because it changes the notes the instrument receives.

- **Bitwig Studio:** put it in the Note FX slot of an instrument track, or anywhere before the instrument in the device chain. Use the CLAP version.
- **Other hosts:** use it as a MIDI effect in front of an instrument. VST3 has no MIDI-effect category, so a host that only routes MIDI between MIDI effects may not accept the VST3 there. The CLAP version is declared as a note effect.

Choose a KEY and a SCALE, then play the white keys from middle C upwards. That's all of it.



The controls

Control	Range	Default	What it does
Power switch (top right)	On / Off	On	Easy Mode on, or every event passes through unchanged.
KEY	C to B	C	The scale's root: the note middle C plays. Clicking a key of the keyboard sets it too.

Control	Range	Default	What it does
SCALE	14 scales	Major	The scale the white keys walk through.

The status line in the header says what middle C plays and the scale, for example `C3 = F · F minor`, or `bypassed` when the power switch is off. The version is in the bottom-right corner, and clicking the logo opens the plugin's page.

How to use it

What the white keys play

Every white key is one step of the scale. Middle C (C3, MIDI note 60) plays the root, the next white key up plays the next note of the scale, and white keys below middle C walk down it. Black keys play nothing.

Scale	White keys C3 D3 E3 F3 G3 A3 B3 C4 play
C Major	C3 D3 E3 F3 G3 A3 B3 C4 (unchanged)
F Natural Minor	F3 G3 Ab3 Bb3 C4 Db4 Eb4 F4
G Major	G2 A2 B2 C3 D3 E3 F#3 G3

Roots C to F sit on or above middle C, and F# to B just below it, so the playable range stays centred.

Scales with fewer or more notes

The octave no longer lines up with seven white keys when a scale doesn't have seven notes. A five-note pentatonic repeats every five white keys, and Chromatic every twelve. So on a pentatonic your hands cover more than an octave of pitch for the same reach, which makes fast runs easy.

Changing key while you play

You can change the key, the scale or the power switch while holding notes. A held note keeps sounding until you let go of its key, and then the right note ends, so nothing gets stuck.

Good to know

- **Other MIDI:** pitch bend, mod wheel and other CCs, channel pressure and program changes pass through untouched. Poly aftertouch and per-note expressions follow their note.
- **Two keys, one note:** if two keys would play the same note on one channel, the second is ignored. Notes that would land outside MIDI's 0 to 127 are dropped.
- **Latency:** none. There is no audio in it at all.
- **Hosts:** the CLAP passes `clap-validator`, and the VST3 loads in Carla's plugin scanner.
- **Display:** X11, or XWayland on a Wayland desktop, with a Vulkan driver.

Troubleshooting

- **The plugin doesn't show up:** check that the bundle is in `~/.clap`, `~/.vst3`, `/usr/lib/clap` or `/usr/lib/vst3`, then rescan plugins in your DAW.

- The editor window stays black or doesn't open: check that a Vulkan driver is installed. The `vulkaninfo` tool from `vulkan-tools` should list your GPU. Bitwig Studio writes plugin errors to `~/.BitwigStudio/log/engine.log`.